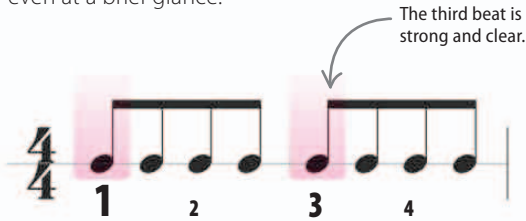


Beaming in 4/4

In 4/4, the third beat is stronger than the second or fourth. Even eighth notes can be beamed across the first or second half of the measure, but not across the middle, so that the third beat remains clear for performers, even at a brief glance.

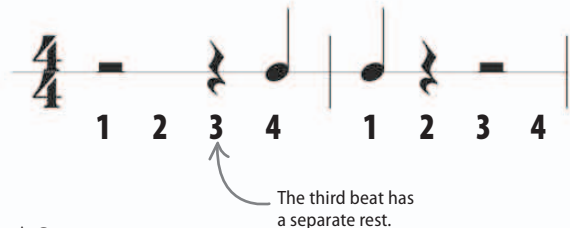


△ Even eighth notes in 4/4 time

This is a common arrangement, with the eighth notes beamed in two groups of four, provided they are even. More varied rhythms—for instance dotted rhythms—may be clearer with each beat beamed separately.

Rests in 4/4

As with notes, it is best to avoid having a rest that crosses the middle of a 4/4 measure. Two separate rests can be used instead, as in the example below. A performer, who will be subconsciously counting the beat, will grasp the rhythm at a glance.

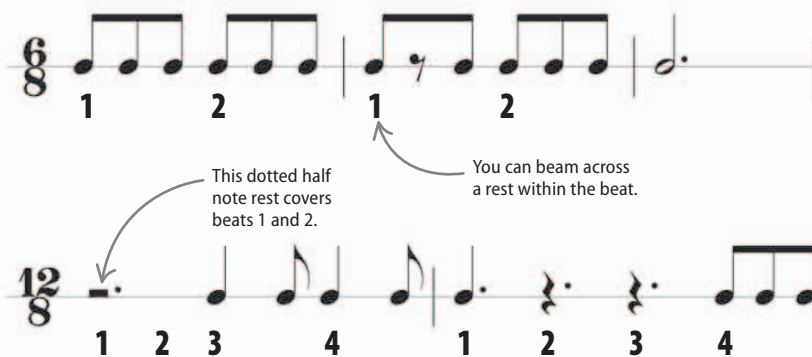


△ Separate rests

This example shows how rests are used to make the 4/4 meter clear, with the third beat always visible.

Compound time

In compound time, the beats should always be clear. They should not be crossed by a note, beam, or rest—except for long notes that last for two whole beats or more. The examples below show how this works in practice.



◁ 6/8 time

In this example, the beat, with its subdivisions into three eighth notes, is very clear.

▽ 12/8 time

This example is more complicated, so the rests are arranged to show the beats clearly.

LOOKING CLOSER

Using ties within the measure

With tied notes, the same principles apply as for beams and rests. The notation should be made as clear as possible for a performer. In 4/4, the third beat should usually be visible, although with very simple rhythms this may not be necessary.



◁ Simple rhythm

In simple rhythms, long notes may cross the middle of the 4/4 measure.

◁ Complicated rhythm

For more complicated rhythms, a tie is used to show the third beat.